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Public Speaking

Lecture 20- Classroom Interaction

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Classroom: Initial Site of Learning

- ❑ Classroom is not only about teaching but learning too.
- ❑ There should be teacher-student as well as student-student communication in order to attain growth and exposure.
- ❑ It is the first institution outside home that plays a vital role in shaping an individual's personality.



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Components of Classroom teaching-learning

Language
used by
Teacher

Teacher's
Feedback

Learner's
interaction
with teacher

Providing
Safe space

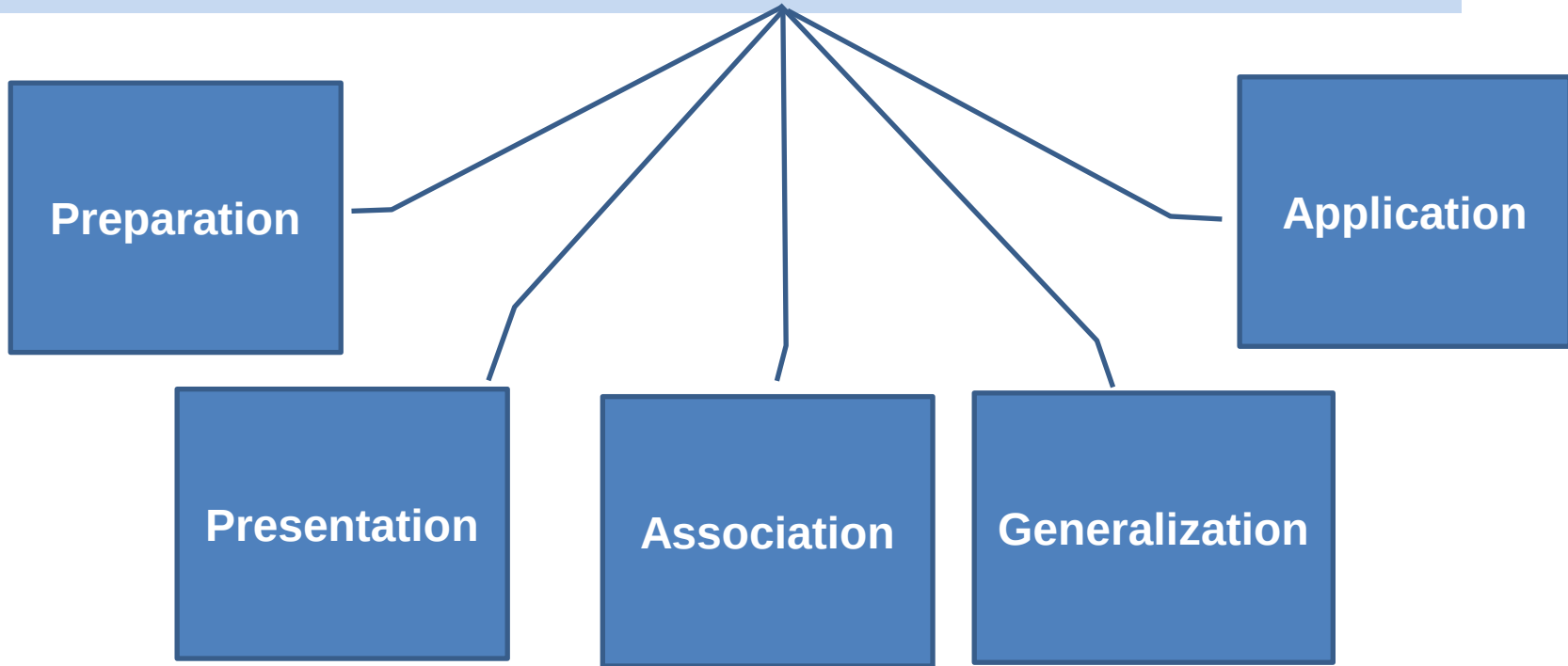
Motivation

Healthy
Criticism

Teacher's Role: Challenges and Changes

- ❖ Since students are required to actively participate in the classroom unlike in earlier times when they were only listeners, it becomes the job of the teacher to make it possible.
- ❖ Teachers are required to avail learning experiences that invoke a quest for knowledge, capture curiosity, trigger imagination, and interest.
- ❖ Teachers are also required to allow students to set goals, solve problems, and make choices in terms of their learning.
- ❖ With the change in lifestyle and experiences, and students belonging to a choice-driven, consumer-oriented society, challenge teachers' knowledge, and authority.

Herbart's Class Teaching Theory



Dewey's Philosophy of Education

- American educator and philosopher John Dewey in the 20th century propounded "child-centered theory" and emphasized democracy in education: "Since in the democratic society we think there is no external authority influence, it must use the voluntary disposition and interest to replace it; and the voluntary tendency and interest can only be formed through education " (Dewey, 2001)
- Dewey's philosophy of education highlights the importance of imagination to drive thinking and learning forward, and for teachers to provide opportunities for students to suspend judgement, engage in the playful consideration of possibilities, and explore doubtful possibilities. (Hargraves)

Classroom Interaction In Philosophy

(Keqing Chai, The Principles
and the Ways of Classroom
Interaction)



Teacher-centered Stage



Student-centered Stage



Dual –Subject Stage



The Stage of
Intersubjectivity

Teacher-centered Stage

- ❖ The traditional classroom teaching complies with Herbart's 'class teaching' theory.
- ❖ European classroom arrangement with teacher's desk stationed right at the front of the classroom.
- ❖ Neat arrangement of rows for the students.
- ❖ Teacher speaks and students ardently listen and take notes.
- ❖ Teacher is vested with power, knowledge, and authority.
- ❖ Students are always on the receiving end.
- ❖ There are a handful of classroom interactive activities.
- ❖ No freedom or rights for students.

Student-centered Stage

- With Dewey's "child-centered theory" in the 20th century, the emphasis shifted to the needs of children and their growth in classroom teaching.
- Teacher's role shrunk.
- There was a radical shift from one end to another.
- According to Tao Xingzhi, a student of Dewey, "Democracy and education is to teach people to be the master, to be their own masters, be the masters of the country, to be the masters of the world." (East China Normal University, 1989)
- However, teacher's full potential was not utilized because of the lop-sidedness of the theory.

Dual Subject Stage

- With the ineffective teacher-centered and student-centered approaches, a shift was observed where teachers, as well as students, became the subject of education.
- The implementation, however, retained the previous fallacy- the imbalance of power.
- Role of the teacher always asserted more authority over the students.
- Very little agency was left with the students in this set-up.

The Stage of Subjectivity

- The communication theory is heavily dependent on its fundamental tenet- **intersubjectivity**- in the 20th century.
- In this, "teachers and students reach an understanding and agreement for the purpose through communication. It is mainly through mutual communication and coordination of social conformity to reach an understanding, the formation of non forced consciousness." (Zhaoli, 2000)
- There is democratic communication between teacher and student through mutual understanding.
- In this, there is no opposite end but all on the same side- booth teacher and student.

Principles of Classroom Interaction pertaining to Intersubjectivity

Principles of
democracy,
equality and
interaction

Listening and
understanding

Dialogue

Reaching a
consensus as the
goal

Principles of Democracy, Equality and Interaction

- Only when the teachers and students are willing to be democratic and be a subject and regard each other as the subject, the relationship between teachers and students becomes the relationship of intersubjectivity and the relationship of democracy (Wenwu 2009).
- The basic principle of the classroom comprises equality and democracy.
- Teacher, in this interaction, cannot impose or force students on anything.
- Students cease to be the education customers.

Listening and Understanding

- ❖ Mutual understanding is as essential as equality and democracy in the interaction between teacher and student.
- ❖ The relevance of listening during interaction cannot be undermined.
- ❖ It is a two-way communication- both the teacher and student need to listen and be empathetic.
- ❖ Students should not be absent-minded during the interaction.
- ❖ Long term efforts are required to attain desired communication goals.

Dialogue

- A decisive role is played by the social environment when it comes to the process of teaching and learning.
- How the information is being transmitted has an upper hand.
- Education mode has to be focused on teaching material and education content.
- Democratic communication should exist between teacher and student through the medium of sincere dialogue.

Reaching a Consensus as The Goal

- ❑ Classroom interaction does not consist of uninterrupted dialogue and negotiation alone.
- ❑ Like mentioned earlier, it comprises interaction from the ends.
- ❑ The interaction has to unhinge itself from the narrowed fusion and register itself to the new horizon.
- ❑ Teaching has to be participatory.

Ways of Classroom Interaction

Organizing quizzes between Teacher-student/
Student-student

Keeping an eye on students' real needs of
learning

Taking care of the emotional needs of the
students

Multiple rounds of dialogues on a regular basis

Being sensitive about the student's real-life and
future career goals

Promote the participation of students in decision
making

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“Education is the passport to the future, for tomorrow belongs to those who prepare for it today.”

—Malcolm X

Thank You